



Replicating Muis et al. (2022): Project Objective & Core Question

- **Original Research Question (Muis et al. 2022):**
 - Does political distrust predict far-right voting differently when far-right parties are in government versus in opposition?
- **Term Paper Objective:**
 - To replicate the main regression analysis from Muis et al. (2022), assessing the robustness of their ‘inclusion-moderation’ finding.
- **Course Alignment:**
 - The project follows the ‘Replication’ option (Alternative 1) as defined in the Research Design syllabus and the submitted term paper proposal.

Data Sources for Replication



Individual-Level Data: European Social Survey (ESS)

- Utilizing Rounds 1–8 (2002-2016) for individual-level variables.
- Includes respondent vote choice, political trust, attitudes on immigration, authoritarianism, and key demographics.

Contextual-Level Data: ParlGov Database

- Used to identify periods of far-right party participation in national governments.
- Provides the data needed to construct the key moderator variable.

Status & Feasibility:

- All data sources are publicly available and have been successfully acquired, confirming project feasibility.

Author Contact Yielded Key Supporting Materials

Proactive Clarification:

- Contacted the original author to resolve ambiguities in data construction and variable coding mentioned in the proposal.



Author-Provided Documentation:

- Received SPSS syntax files documenting the logic for constructing key predictor and control variables.
- Obtained intermediate datasets that precisely assign cabinet periods based on individual survey interview dates.
- Acquired the original party classification materials for coding the dependent variable.

Application within Course Guidelines:

- These materials serve as a blueprint to guide the independent reconstruction of the analysis logic in R, ensuring high fidelity while adhering to the syllabus requirement of original programming.

Current Progress and Reproducible Workflow



Data Management

Data Management:

- All eight waves of the European Social Survey (ESS) have been imported, processed, and merged into a single analytical dataset.



Variable Reconstruction

Variable Reconstruction (In Progress):

- Actively translating the author's SPSS logic into R scripts to reconstruct key variables:
 - Political trust scale
 - Immigration attitudes
 - Authoritarianism



Contextual Merge

Contextual Merge (Next Step):

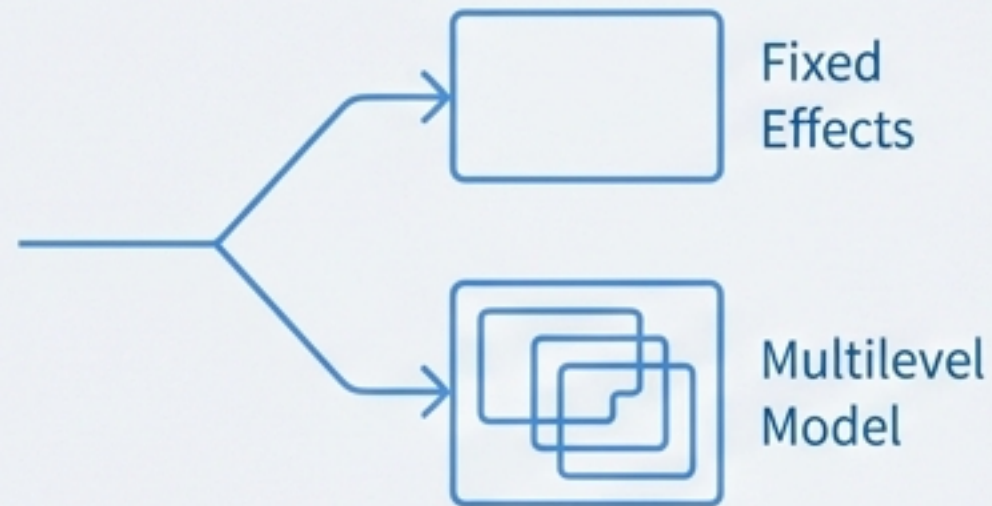
- Implementing the interview-date-based assignment of cabinet periods to link individual and contextual data accurately.



Transparency and Documentation:

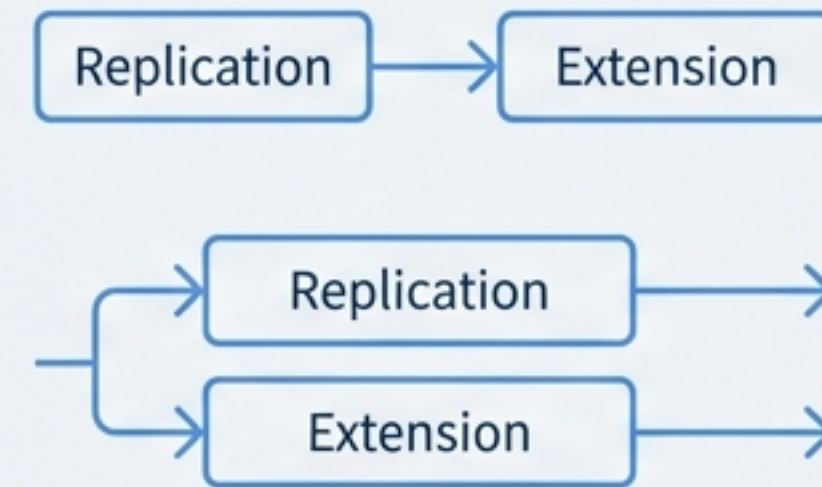
- All scripts, data-cleaning decisions, and progress are version-controlled and documented in a public GitHub repository to ensure full reproducibility.

Open Methodological Questions for Discussion



1. Model Specification: Fidelity vs. Feasibility

- The term paper proposal outlined a simplified logistic regression with country fixed effects, anticipating implementation challenges.
- The author-provided materials now make a direct replication of the original **multilevel specification** feasible.
- **Question:** Given the goal of a high-quality replication, is pursuing the more complex multilevel model advisable for this term paper, or is the simplified fixed-effects approach more appropriate?



2. Extension Strategy: Depth vs. Breadth

- The original proposal includes extensions using immigration salience and post-2016 ESS waves (Rounds 9-10).
- **Question:** Should the primary focus be on executing a high-fidelity replication of the original 2002-2016 model first, or is it methodologically sound to pursue the planned extensions in parallel?